



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Valor Christian High School

School Website: <https://valorchristian.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Valor Christian High School (Highlands Ranch, CO; 80126) presents a clearly Christian, Christ-centered educational environment with emphasis on character formation, virtue, and spiritual formation. Public materials emphasize Christ-centered identity, prayer, Bible study, and discipleship as central to student development, alongside college-preparatory academics and mentorship. These religious foundations align with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Parents/Community dimensions of the classical rubric. However, explicit classical elements such as Great Books, the Great Conversation, grammar/logic/rhetoric as a curricular spine, and overt Socratic pedagogy are not prominently evidenced in available public materials. Pedagogical approaches (e.g., Socratic seminars, Schol  -style contemplative learning) are not clearly articulated on the site, and the curriculum is presented in a broader Christian curriculum framework with emphasis on college preparation and disciplinary offerings rather than a formal classical curriculum. Faculty are described as skilled, mission-focused mentors, which aligns with the Faculty criterion. Parent involvement and community engagement are evident through campus visits, family involvement initiatives, and parent-facing offerings.

Overall, Valor Christian High School exhibits substantial classical-adjacent strengths in Religious Foundations, Faculty, and Parents/Community, moderate alignment in School Purpose/Goal, and weaker alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy. Aggregate assessment: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

Evidence and synthesis draw on Valor's published materials, including campus history statements about a Christian mission, Bible and theology emphasis, and role of mentors; plus admissions and campus pages describing family involvement and community life. Key sources include Valor's site pages discussing the Christian mission and discipleship (e.g., History and Bible department language), campus life, and family/community focus. See citations to the school's public materials for specifics.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The founding vision emphasizes Christianity as the core: "Above all, it would be decidedly Christian, dedicated to impart the Christian mind and a Christian ethic through grace and truth" (History page). This signals transcendental moral realism and a theological grounding.
- Bible department statement describes discipleship and formation around Jesus and the Holy Spirit as central to education.
- Public materials repeatedly frame education as Christ-centered and faith-informed (e.g., "Christ-centered education," "go into the world and transform the world for Christ").
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (mapped to Classical lexicon): Christ-centered, grace and truth, disciples, Holy Spirit, Bible, Jesus, God, Christian mind. These align with the Positive Indicators for religious/theological foundations (theology, liturgy, sacred text, discipleship, etc.). Estimated presence: 6–7 distinct positive terms.
- Negative keywords: none explicitly evident (no explicit signals of relativism, secularism, or values-clarification in the public materials examined).
- Why this rating
- The material strongly foregrounds theology, discipleship, Scripture, and worship-oriented language, consistent with Transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty as reflected in a Christian frame) and liturgical/community practices. While there is not a formal liturgy schedule detailed, explicit communal practices and Bible/theology emphasis anchor this category as CLASSICAL in practice, though the overall program is framed through a Christian lens rather than a secular classical canon. Rating rationale reflects strong religious/metaphysical grounding with no conspicuous counter-signals.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize formation and virtue through a Christ-centered frame and personal development (e.g., “Christ-centered education,” mentoring, counseling, and formation aims). The History narrative emphasizes excellence and a high spiritual/substantive standard.
- Discovery experiences, mentorship, and guidance are described as core components of Valor’s model, signaling formation beyond mere information.
- There is explicit college-preparatory emphasis (AP/dual credit) alongside faith formation; the explicit goal statements about virtue, wisdom, and formation are not codified in the same way as a classical “paideia” telos, but they imply a formation-centric aim.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (mapped): formation, virtue (implied by “excellence in all things” and spiritual formation), wisdom, telos (implicit in a mission to form character for Christ and leadership, though not stated with classical vocabulary), contemplation/rest (scholé) is not explicitly stated, but there is emphasis on contemplation in a faith-context sense. Approx. presence of 2–4 positive concepts explicitly echoed.
- Negative keywords: explicit references to “workforce preparation” or 21st-century skills as the sole goal are not strongly present; however the site does emphasize college readiness and career pathways (AP/dual credit), which can coexist with formation but signals a stronger tilt toward information/credential outcomes than pure formation per se.
- Why this rating
- The school communicates formation and virtue-oriented aims through a Christian lens, with some emphasis on wisdom and classical-oriented aims, but the explicit articulation of virtue-centered formation as a sole or primary telos is less robust than a fully Classical paideia framework. Consequently, the rating is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting partial alignment with classical aims (formation and virtue) but not the full-pedagogical/teleological articulation typical of classical schools.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Curriculum content is described in terms of standard high school offerings (AP courses, dual credit, etc.) with a Christian lens. There is mention of English, Bible, Mathematics, Technology, etc., but no explicit articulation of liberal arts spine (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or the full quadrivium/trivium framework. The course catalog shows Bible, English, Mathematics, Technology, etc., but does not present a canonical Great Books program or “Great Conversation” framework.
- English department language emphasizes engagement with “worthy texts” and “timeless conversation about the great thoughts and ideas,” which hints at literary engagement but not the classical Great Books program or explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric sequencing.

- The school's textual materials focus on Christian faith contexts rather than a classical curriculum architecture (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin/Greek, or explicit Great Books sequencing). The Great Books/-Great Conversation vocabulary does not appear as an explicit curricular pillar.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (mapped): "great thoughts," "timeless conversation" (signals some classical sensibility), "texts," "humanities" (without explicit Great Books framing). However, explicit classical curricular markers such as grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; inclusion of history as a core through the Great Conversation; or mandated memorization/recitation are not clearly evidenced.
- Negative keywords present: absence of "Great Books," "Great Conversation" as formal curricular anchors; absence of explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric sequencing; absence of Latin/Greek within the visible materials.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum is framed in a Christian college-prep context rather than a formal Classical curriculum with the liberal arts backbone (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation). While there is engagement with literature and "texts," the explicit classical curriculum architecture is not demonstrated. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Pedagogical descriptions emphasize mentorship, Christ-centered counseling, and college-prep rigor, rather than explicit classical methods such as Socratic seminars in the lower/upper school, disciplined memory work, recitation, or scholé-based contemplative learning. The materials do not clearly present Socratic dialogues, seminars, or debates as a formalized pedagogy, nor do they present a program of structured memory work or recitation akin to classical teaching.
- There is mention of a "collegiate" schedule and experiential learning in some program descriptions, but not a classical pedagogy emphasis (no explicit "Scholé," participant-led dialectic, or rhetoric-focused training details).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (mapped): "Socratic" (not explicitly found as a school-wide practice), "recitation" or "memory work" (not clearly evidenced in Valor's pedagogy), "narration" or "chanting" (not clearly evidenced). The site does describe mentoring and Christ-centered approaches, which map loosely to some classical ideals but are not explicit pedagogy terms in the cataloged public content.
- Negative keywords present: absence of explicit Socratic seminars, explicit scholé days, or formal memory/chanting practices; absence of project-based learning as the sole pedagogy in the classical sense.
- Why this rating
- The public materials do not present a clear, classical pedagogy (Socratic method, scholé, memory-based recitation, or formal rhetorical training). They emphasize a faith-centered, college-prep approach with mentorship. This yields NOT CLASSICAL in pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe faculty as "passionate experts in their subject areas" who "invest in the lives of students," signaling model teachers and mentors. There is an emphasis on mentorship and the living curriculum; the faculty are presented as central to student formation.
- There are references to faculty involved in mission-aligned activities (discipleship, counseling, mentorship), implying a living, relational curriculum and a portrait of what makes a teacher and student.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: "model teachers and mentors," "living curriculum," "faculty as the core of the school," "mentors," "collegiality and virtue," which map well to the Classical Faculty indicators.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials.
- Why this rating

- The materials strongly indicate teacher leadership, mentorship, and a shared mission, consistent with CLASSICAL faculty indicators. The absence of explicit negative signals reinforces CLASSICAL status for this category.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Valor emphasizes partnership with parents, viewing parents as co-teachers and inviting family involvement through campus visits, personal tours, shadow days, and parent-facing communications. They actively welcome parents and emphasize parental engagement in the Valor community.
- The site describes parent formation opportunities (book studies, gatherings) and open-campus or visit opportunities. The “Three Opportunities to Visit Valor” section highlights active parental engagement and transparency.
- Public materials emphasize community-building, clubs, traditions, and service opportunities that foster parental involvement and community partnerships.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, parent involvement, family-centered activities, community life, parental engagement.
- Negative keywords: none evident; no consumer-only language or minimal parental involvement signals.
- Why this rating
- Val or’s public materials strongly support parental partnership, family formation, and engaged community involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parent & Community involvement.

What Would Move the Needle

- To push Valor toward a FULLY CLASSICAL profile, implement explicit classical curriculum and pedagogy signals:
- Adopt and publish a formal classical curriculum spine (grammar, logic, rhetoric), with a stated plan for Great Books exploration and a “Great Conversation” framework across relevant grade levels.
- Introduce explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades (and clearly document the use of Socratic seminars and dialectic discussions) along with opportunities for students to deliver rhetorical speeches and capstone projects.
- Restore, emphasize, and publicize formal memory work, recitation, and chanting where appropriate (e.g., poetry, catechesis, or classical texts) as part of routine instruction.
- Elevate and articulate a more explicit telos-focused statement that centers virtue, wisdom, and human excellence as the primary aims of education (over and above college-prep in a broad sense).
- Expand the Great Books/Great Conversation framing in curriculum materials, course catalogs, and parent communications to demonstrate a canonical classical approach.
- Where possible, implement a more explicit liberal-arts course sequence (grammar□stage, logic, rhetoric), and highlight Latin/Greek study if applicable to the school’s program.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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